🚀 **MindCare Portal: Team Onboarding Guide**

Welcome to the team! We have set up the foundational boilerplate for our Django backend and React/Vite frontend.

Please follow these exact steps to get the app running on your own computer.

Part 1: Cloning the Code & Setup

Step 1: Clone the Repository

Open your terminal (Command Prompt, PowerShell, or Git Bash) and run:

bash

git clone https://github.com/YOUR_GITHUB_USERNAME/Digital-Psychological-Intervention-System.git

cd Digital-Psychological-Intervention-System

(Replace YOUR_GITHUB_USERNAME with the actual link to our repository).

Step 2: Set Up the Backend (Django)

Open a terminal inside the backend folder:

bash

cd backend

1. **Create a Virtual Environment:**

bash

python -m venv venv

2. **Activate the Virtual Environment:**
    - **Windows:** .\venv\Scripts\activate
    - **Mac/Linux:** source venv/bin/activate *(You should see*

(venv) appear in your terminal).

3. **Install Python Dependencies:**

bash

pip install -r requirements.txt

4. **Set up Local Environment Variables:**
    - Create a file named exactly

.env inside the backend folder.

- Open the

.env.example file, copy everything inside it, and paste it into your new

.env file.

- *Required: Ask Tejas for the real MONGO_URI Atlas connection string and paste it into*

.env.

Step 3: Set Up the Frontend (React/Vite)

Open a **new, split terminal window** inside the frontend folder:

bash

cd "Digital Psychological Intervention System (1)"

1. **Install Node.js Dependencies:**

bash

npm install

2. **Set up Local Environment Variables:**
    - Create a file named exactly

.env inside the frontend folder.

- Copy the contents of

.env.example into your new

.env file.

Part 2: Starting the Servers & Database

You need **two** terminal windows open to run the app.

1. **Start the Backend (Terminal 1):**

bash

cd backend

.\venv\Scripts\activate

python manage.py runserver

(Backend starts at http://localhost:8000 connected to our shared MongoDB Atlas cloud).

2. **Start the Frontend (Terminal 2):**

bash

cd "Digital Psychological Intervention System (1)"

npm run dev

(Frontend starts at http://localhost:5173. Click the link to view the app!)

Part 3: How to Safely Build and Push Code (Crucial!)

To prevent us from accidentally deleting each other's work or breaking the live app, we follow the **Feature Branch Workflow**.

NEVER write code directly on the main branch!

Step 1: Get the Latest Code

Before you start coding for the day, always make sure you have the newest updates from the rest of the team:

bash

git checkout main

git pull origin main

Step 2: Create Your Own Branch

Create a separate branch for the specific feature you are building right now (e.g., login, chat, tests):

bash

git checkout -b feature/your-name-login

(Now you can safely edit files, create pages, and write code!)

Step 3: Save Your Work Locally

When you finish a coding session or complete a feature:

bash

git add .

git commit -m "Added login form UI and connected to backend API"

Step 4: Push to GitHub securely

Send your branch up to the cloud:

bash

```
git push origin feature/your-name-login
```

Step 5: Open a Pull Request (PR)

1. Go to our GitHub repository in your web browser.
2. You will see a green button saying **"Compare & pull request"** next to your newest branch. Click it!
3. Add a quick title explaining what you built.
4. Message the group chat: *"Hey guys, I just opened a PR for the Login screen!"*
5. Another teammate will quickly look at your code on GitHub and click the **Merge** button.

Once merged, everyone else runs git pull origin main to get your new code on their computers!